

REHAB-PT-v5: Outpatient Physical Therapy Coverage

Meridian Health Medical Policy

Policy Number: REHAB-PT-v5

Effective Date: July 1, 2025

SCOPE: Outpatient physical therapy benefits.

STANDARD BENEFIT: 20 visits per episode of care.

EXTENSION CRITERIA: Additional visits (up to 20 more) may be approved when ALL of the following are documented:

1. Member has not yet achieved functional goals stated in the initial plan of care.
2. Documentation shows measurable functional improvement in at least two objective measures (range of motion, strength, functional outcome score such as DASH, Oswestry, LEFS, etc.) over the most recent four weeks.
3. Treating therapist and/or physician provide a written statement that additional visits are expected to result in further measurable improvement within a specific number of additional sessions.
4. Member's progress is not plateaued. A plateau is defined as no measurable improvement in objective metrics over four consecutive weeks.